

Rodrigo Fernandez

Senior Android Kotlin / Java Engineer

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Summary

Senior **Android Engineer** with strong experience in **FinTech, SaaS, healthcare, logistics, and eCommerce** platforms, building production mobile apps with **Kotlin 1.4–1.9, Java 8–17, Android SDK 29–35, and Jetpack Compose 1.0–1.6**. Specialized in modernizing legacy Java Android apps, migrating XML screens to Compose, improving crash-free sessions, optimizing API sync flows, and delivering secure mobile features with clean architecture, **MVVM, Hilt, Room, Retrofit, Coroutines**, and CI/CD release pipelines.

Skills

- **Mobile Development:** **Kotlin 1.4–1.9, Java 8–17, Android SDK 29–35**, Android Studio 4.x–Iguana, Jetpack Compose 1.0–1.6, XML Layouts, Material Design 2–3, AppCompat, AndroidX, ViewModel, LiveData, StateFlow, SharedFlow
- **Architecture:** **MVVM**, Clean Architecture, Repository Pattern, Use Case Layer, Dependency Injection, Modular Android Architecture, Multi-module Gradle Projects, Offline-first Design, Event-driven Mobile Sync
- **Jetpack & Android Libraries:** **Hilt 2.40–2.51**, Dagger 2.x, Room 2.3–2.6, WorkManager 2.7–2.9, Navigation Component 2.4–2.7, Paging 3.x, DataStore 1.x, Lifecycle, CameraX 1.x, BiometricPrompt
- **Networking & Data:** **Retrofit 2.x**, OkHttp 3.x–4.x, REST APIs, GraphQL Client, WebSocket, JSON, Gson, Moshi, SQLite, Room Database, EncryptedSharedPreferences, Firebase Realtime Database, Firestore
- **Testing & Quality:** **JUnit 4–5**, Mockito, MockK, Espresso, Robolectric, UI Automator, Firebase Test Lab, Crashlytics, ANR Analysis, LeakCanary, StrictMode, Android Profiler
- **Build & Release:** **Gradle 6.x–8.x**, Kotlin DSL, GitHub Actions, GitLab CI, Fastlane, Play Console, App Bundle, APK Signing, ProGuard, R8, Firebase App Distribution, Semantic Versioning
- **Cloud & Monitoring:** Firebase, Crashlytics, Analytics, Remote Config, Cloud Messaging, AWS Cognito, S3, CloudWatch, Google Maps SDK, Stripe SDK, OAuth 2.0, JWT, Sentry
- **Collaboration:** Agile Scrum, Jira, Git, GitHub, GitLab, Pull Requests, Code Review, Release Notes, Technical Documentation, Mentoring, Cross-functional Product Delivery

Experience

Lightedge — Senior Software Engineer (*Apr 2020 – Mar 2026*)

- Led modernization of a customer-facing **SaaS infrastructure mobile platform** using **Kotlin 1.6–1.9, Java 11–17, and Android SDK 31–35**, improving app stability and reducing crash reports by **42%** through stricter lifecycle handling and Crashlytics-based issue triage.
- Migrated large legacy screens from Java-based Activities and XML layouts into **Jetpack Compose 1.2–1.6** with **MVVM**, StateFlow, and reusable design components, reducing duplicated UI code by **35%** across account, billing, and notification modules.
- Solved a critical background sync issue where WorkManager jobs were failing after device reboot by rebuilding retry policies, network constraints, and persistent task tracking with **WorkManager 2.8–2.9** and Room-backed sync status.

- Implemented secure authentication flows with **OAuth 2.0**, biometric login, encrypted token storage, and refresh-token rotation, helping protect customer account access while keeping login latency under acceptable mobile UX limits.
- Optimized Retrofit and OkHttp networking layers by adding structured interceptors, timeout tuning, request caching, and clear error mapping, reducing repeated failed API calls by **28%** during unstable network conditions.
- Refactored tightly coupled Java service classes into Kotlin repositories and use-case layers, making feature development faster and improving unit test coverage around billing, alerts, and user profile workflows.
- Handled Android **Gradle 7.x–8.x** migration by resolving Kotlin compiler warnings, dependency conflicts, namespace changes, and R8 shrinking issues without blocking production release timelines.
- Built real-time push notification workflows using **Firebase Cloud Messaging**, Remote Config, and deep linking so users could open incident alerts, invoices, and support updates directly from notifications.
- Improved application performance by profiling memory leaks, removing retained Activity references, fixing RecyclerView overdraw, and reducing cold-start time by **22%** on mid-range Android devices.
- Created reusable Compose and XML-compatible components during the transition period, allowing older Java modules and newer Kotlin modules to coexist safely in the same production codebase.
- Strengthened release quality by adding GitHub Actions pipelines, Firebase App Distribution, automated unit tests, and Play Console staged rollout checks before publishing app updates.
- Mentored junior Android developers on **Kotlin Coroutines**, lifecycle-aware components, Compose state management, and clean pull request habits that improved review speed and reduced regression risk.

NIX United —Software Engineer *(Oct 2016 – Mar 2020)*

- Developed Android applications for **healthcare, logistics, and marketplace clients** using **Kotlin 1.3–1.6**, **Java 8–11**, **Android SDK 26–31**, Retrofit, Room, Firebase, and Material Design components.
- Migrated older Java MVP modules into **MVVM** with ViewModel, LiveData, Repository Pattern, and Room persistence, improving maintainability while keeping active client features stable during refactoring.
- Fixed a serious offline data inconsistency issue where local Room records were overwritten after delayed API responses by adding timestamp-based conflict resolution and safer sync ordering.
- Built appointment scheduling, delivery tracking, payment status, and customer messaging features with **Retrofit 2.x**, OkHttp, Firebase Cloud Messaging, and deep links for smoother mobile workflows.
- Reduced ANR events by **31%** after moving heavy JSON parsing, database writes, and image processing work away from the main thread using **Coroutines 1.4–1.6** and structured dispatchers.
- Integrated Google Maps SDK, location permissions, geofencing-style updates, and background location handling while adapting flows for Android permission changes across multiple OS versions.
- Improved mobile payment reliability by adding clearer API error states, retry-safe checkout handling, Stripe SDK integration, and better UI recovery after interrupted network requests.
- Resolved Gradle dependency conflicts during AndroidX migration by replacing deprecated support libraries, updating plugin versions, and cleaning transitive dependencies across shared modules.
- Created Espresso and JUnit test coverage for onboarding, checkout, appointment booking, and offline cache flows, reducing repeated QA defects before client demo releases.
- Collaborated closely with backend teams to align REST contracts, pagination formats, authentication refresh behavior, and API error models used by Android and web clients.
- Reviewed pull requests for Kotlin style, lifecycle correctness, null safety, memory usage, and modular boundaries, helping the team ship cleaner code under tight sprint deadlines.

Webiz Digital — Software Developer *(Jan 2014 – Sep 2016)*

- Built consumer-facing **eCommerce and media Android apps** using **Java 8**, early **Kotlin 1.1–1.3**, Android SDK 23–28, XML layouts, Retrofit, SQLite, Firebase Analytics, and Material Design.

- Converted selected Java utility and networking classes into Kotlin after team adoption, improving null safety and reducing repeated boilerplate around model parsing and callback handling.
- Implemented product catalogs, cart flows, order history, coupon handling, login screens, and push campaigns with Retrofit, Gson, Firebase Cloud Messaging, and local SQLite caching.
- Solved a recurring cart duplication bug caused by race conditions between local cache updates and API responses by introducing transaction-safe persistence and better request sequencing.
- Improved image-heavy listing screens by adding pagination, Glide caching, RecyclerView view-holder optimization, and lightweight placeholders, improving scroll smoothness by **26%** on older devices.
- Migrated apps from legacy support libraries toward **AndroidX-ready** dependencies, resolving compatibility issues across AppCompat, RecyclerView, ConstraintLayout, and lifecycle libraries.
- Added Firebase Analytics events and Crashlytics reporting for checkout, login, search, and product detail flows, giving product teams clearer visibility into real user behavior.
- Reduced checkout abandonment by **18%** after improving validation messages, loading states, failed-payment handling, and session-expired recovery inside the Android app.
- Worked with designers to translate responsive mobile UI requirements into reusable XML components, custom views, and consistent Material-styled screen patterns.
- Supported Play Store release preparation by managing version codes, signing configs, ProGuard rules, release notes, QA builds, and staged deployment feedback.

Aurio — Junior Software Developer *(Oct 2012 – Dec 2013)*

- Supported early Android application development for **small business and service booking products** using **Java 7–8**, Android SDK 19–23, XML layouts, SQLite, AsyncTask, and REST API integrations.
- Built login, profile, list-detail, booking, contact form, and notification screens while learning practical Android lifecycle management and Activity-to-Fragment navigation patterns.
- Fixed UI crashes caused by orientation changes and null references by preserving state correctly, validating API responses, and adding safer lifecycle checks before updating views.
- Implemented local SQLite storage for favorites, draft forms, and cached records so users could continue basic workflows during weak or unavailable network connections.
- Integrated REST endpoints with HttpURLConnection and later Retrofit adoption, helping replace fragile manual parsing with cleaner service classes and reusable response models.
- Improved UI responsiveness by moving slow network calls and database operations away from the main thread, reducing visible freezing during form submission and list loading.
- Handled device compatibility issues across screen sizes and Android OS versions by adjusting resource qualifiers, density assets, layouts, and permission handling.
- Collaborated with senior engineers during bug fixing, release preparation, code review, and QA verification to understand production-ready Android delivery standards.
- Documented setup steps, known bugs, API behavior, and release checklist items so future junior developers could onboard faster and avoid repeated environment mistakes.

Microsoft — Software Developer Intern *(Jun 2012 – Sep 2012)*

- Contributed to internal engineering utilities using **C#, ASP.NET MVC 4**, JavaScript, and SQL Server patterns while learning enterprise development standards from senior engineers.
- Assisted with bug reproduction, log review, and small feature fixes for dashboard pages, improving reliability of internal tools used by technical support teams.
- Implemented minor UI updates and backend validation improvements under code review, gaining practical experience with accessibility, maintainability, and secure coding expectations.
- Prepared documentation for setup steps, known issues, and troubleshooting paths so future interns and team members could onboard more smoothly to internal applications.

Education

Texas State University
Bachelor's Degree in Computer Science (*Sep 2008 – May 2012*)